



"There were significant challenges for us in the political climate back home. My mother is now a public figure in the Netherlands, but she was imprisoned from a young age in Iran for political reasons. It was extremely difficult for our family — 'difficult' is a soft word. It was impossible for us to live there," Gademan recalls.

He is deeply grateful for the opportunities provided by his parents and the Netherlands. "I've grown up in a free, Western world. As first-generation immigrants, my parents worked hard to study, learn, and provide us with a life of free will and choice in every aspect. I've been given that in a country that, despite its challenges, offers tremendous beauty and opportunity," he says.

When Verga offered him the role

at Almere, Gademan saw it as an opportunity to evolve. He kept Almere in the Hoofdklasse for two consecutive seasons before moving on to become assistant coach to Andre Henning at Rot-Weiss in Cologne, Germany.

The duo later reversed roles with the Canada men's national team in 2020, before switching again in 2022 with the German national team, which went on to become World Champion and Olympic silver medallist.

Now, Gademan is seeking his next challenge with Toofans in the HIL, aiming to win a competition unlike anything he has experienced.

"You are comparing very different elements. We don't have anything like this, where you just form a new team, buy some players, and get

At the helm: Gademan (right) has played a pivotal role in guiding his team to consistent success in the 2024-25 Hockey India League.

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started," he says.

Gademan is cautious when it comes to stating his ambitions, yet he is eager to continue chasing the rush of working at the top level. "It's the nerves, the unknown, the tension... whatever it is, you become addicted to the thrill and the performance side of things. That's unfortunately what happens with sport — you're always searching for the next high. That's one of the reasons I'm here. This is about searching for the next high. This is living it and experiencing it," he concludes.